

Critical Thinking Assignment

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1. Identify the biases that you are now able to relate to in your past experience. List the top three biases.

Looking back at my past projects, I can clearly identify a few cognitive biases that influenced my decision-making. The top three biases I relate to are:

1. **Confirmation Bias:** I recall a time when I favoured information that supported my initial theory about why a feature was failing, and I unintentionally ignored logs that pointed to a different root cause.
2. **Anchoring Bias:** During a sprint planning session, I fixated on the first time-estimate thrown out by a colleague, which skewed my own estimation for the rest of the tasks.
3. **The Halo Effect:** I once assumed a piece of code was flawless simply because it was written by a senior developer I highly respected, leading me to skip a thorough review."

2. Did you catch yourself when you went through Fast (Non-Conscious) Thinking and Slow (Deliberate) Thinking? Share your experience.

I recently caught myself transitioning between these two modes during a production deployment. An unexpected error popped up, and my immediate, 'Fast Thinking' reaction was a mix of panic and a strong urge to instantly roll back the entire deployment to feel safe.

However, I caught myself acting on impulse. I took a breath and intentionally switched to 'Slow Thinking.' I deliberately opened the logs, traced the error down to a minor configuration typo, and realized we could apply a quick hotfix instead of a full rollback. Catching that instinct saved us a lot of downtime.

3. Do you think eliminating emotions completely would be the right way to think critically? Share your experiences

I do not believe that eliminating emotions completely is the right way to think critically. While raw, unchecked emotions like anger or panic can derail logical problem-solving,

emotions also provide crucial context. Empathy, for instance, is an emotion that is necessary when designing user interfaces or understanding why a client is frustrated.

In my experience, the goal isn't to turn off emotions, but to recognize them, understand where they are coming from, and prevent them from overriding objective facts. Critical thinking works best when logic is paired with emotional intelligence.

4. Pick a problem or bug that you worked on few months back. Now with this new awareness, how would you define the problem statement better if the problem was given to you today? Which method helped you to define the problem statement better?

Sometime back, I was assigned a bug simply titled 'Data not showing on the UI.' At the time, I just started blindly testing the interface. If given that problem today, I would define the statement much more precisely. Using the '**5 Whys**' method, I would drill down past the surface level.

Instead of 'Data not showing', my problem statement would be: 'The Angular component's signal is not triggering a view update because the Spring Boot backend is returning a cached, mutated object rather than a completely new reference.' The 5 Whys method helped me shift from describing the *symptom* to defining the actual *root cause*, which makes finding the solution much faster."